Henry C. Shires

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The backbone of modern society is the field of engineering. The incredible feats of problem-solving and innovating have skyrocketed population growth and life expectancy in today's humans, and without the combination of science and technology to solve global problems, life would not be the same as we know it today. Thus, this field proves its importance to most and its influence on everyone worldwide. And with such importance and influence comes its ability to dictate how future generations will continue to live. Therefore, this critical field and its members must reflect the needs and values of all members of the global population with its solutions, making diversity and inclusion a key topic to discuss with all engineers.

Since no two people are the same, varying in skills and life experiences, it is paramount that engineers diversify the teams they work with day-to-day to broaden their scope of ideation and requirements gathering. The more perspectives included in brainstorming and discussion, the more likely a near-perfect solution will be discovered, as all of these combined life experiences can highlight key facts or eliminate ineffective solutions. Not only is it important to diversify engineering teams (include all people in the *input* of ideas), but it is just as important to include all people in determining what the solution should look like (include all people in the *outputted* solution). If a solution for a problem impacting multiple groups of people solves the problem for just one group, how effective of a solution is it? Examples like designing tech products to work for both left-handed and right-handed people, as mentioned in the lecture, perfectly illustrate how ideal innovations require diversity in the team (e.g., right-handed AND left-handed people to provide their experiences) and inclusivity of its users (creating a solution for both types of people).

For someone with perspectives and experiences like mine, the importance of diversity and inclusion in engineering seems obvious. Everyone in the world is important and deserves quality of life,

so we must ensure all voices are heard, and solutions to problems are tailored to all people affected. Yet, for others, this topic seems annoying or as if people are beating a dead horse. Now, because of this seeming rise of tension, engineers should support diversity and inclusion and determine better ways of educating people on its importance. Our world today has many problems waiting to be solved, whether small or very large, and to solve these problems, we need more than just a handful of engineers with technical knowledge. These solutions require support from thousands to even millions of people, all of whom may be very different from one another. By improving education for these groups and listening to each other more often, we can accelerate reaching solutions to these problems and remove tensions that result in hating this topic.

Change, the very thing engineers strive to create, cannot happen without discomfort and people leaving their similar people groups. Instead is talking to others, willing to share disagreement, but respecting experiences and perspectives that lead to positive change and green lights for engineers to improve the world. It's time for engineers to inspire people to grow, expose them to new ideas, and exemplify kindness for all in their work so that those people may do the same, ignite a spark of unity across the world, and promote sustainability for generations to come.